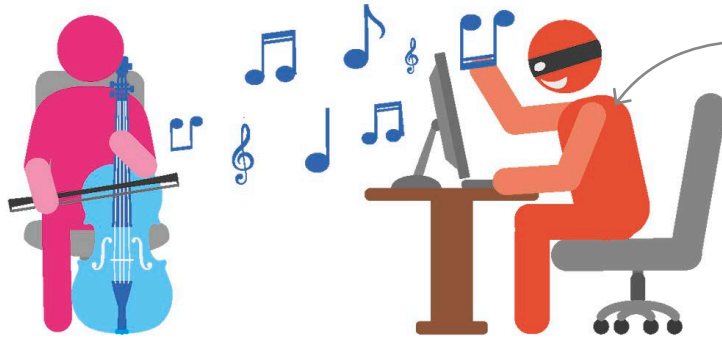


Digital property

Online content, such as photographs or music, is usually owned by its creator. Other people aren't allowed to share it without permission, or claim to have created it. Creators who are happy for others to use, remix, and share their work can release it under a "Creative Commons" agreement.



Using content without permission is bad online behaviour, and can break the law.

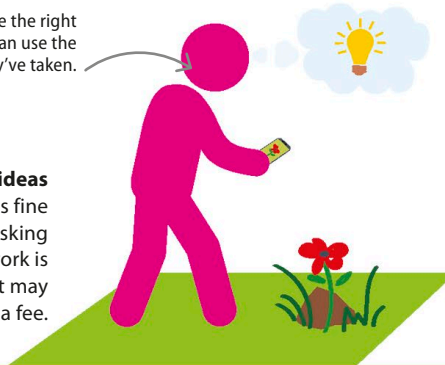
◁ Stealing entertainment

People are less likely to think that consuming digital music or films without paying for them is stealing. However, doing so still deprives the creators of payment for their work.

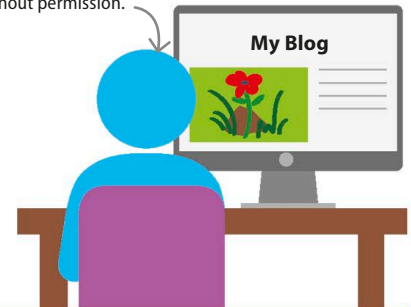
Photographers have the right to decide who can use the photo they've taken.

▷ Stealing ideas

Quoting from someone's work is fine as long as they are credited. Asking permission to use someone's work is often successful, although it may involve paying a fee.



A person who didn't create the original work should not use it without permission.



Interacting online

Interacting with people online is a great opportunity to exchange views and ideas. However, since most online interactions are carried out using text, it increases the chance of conversations running into difficulties. Not being able to see people's facial expressions or hear their tone of voice can result in misunderstandings. People can minimize the risk of encountering problems by following these basic rules for online interaction.

Be polite, truthful, and considerate. No one likes rudeness or lying.

When commenting on a forum or website, follow any rules it states.

Acknowledge when someone has been helpful and help others.

Stay positive when commenting. Say nothing rather than being unkind.

Be respectful when debating and don't resort to personal insults.

Try to keep a sense of perspective on whatever happens online.